

FSPM_Quiz3

Chapter 11: Managing People in Software Environments

1. Which research approach relies on the assumption that systems are governed by mechanistic laws and favors experimentation to establish relationships?

- A) Interpretivist approach
- B) Positivist approach
- C) Constructivist approach
- D) Heuristic approach

Answer: B

Source: "This mindset tends to favour experimentation as the means of establishing the relationships between inputs and outputs and is sometimes referred to as a positivist approach."

3. According to Donald McGregor's Theory X, what is the inherent human attitude towards work?

- A) The average human has an innate dislike of work.
- B) Work is as natural as rest or play.
- C) People naturally seek responsibility.
- D) Commitment to objectives is driven by non-financial rewards.

Answer: A

Source: "Theory X holds that: the average human has an innate dislike of work;"

4. Which of the following statements aligns with McGregor's Theory Y?

- A) People tend to avoid responsibility.
- B) There is a need for coercion, direction, and control.
- C) The capacity to exercise imagination and creativity is widely distributed.
- D) External control is the only way to bring about effort.

Answer: C

Source: "Theory Y, on the other hand, holds that: ... the capacity to exercise imagination and other creative qualities is widely distributed."

5. How does Meredith Belbin distinguish between 'eligible' and 'suitable' candidates during recruitment?

- A) Eligible candidates have the right paper qualifications, whereas suitable candidates can actually do the job well.
- B) Eligible candidates lack experience, whereas suitable candidates have decades of experience.
- C) Eligible candidates can do the job well, whereas suitable candidates only have the right paper qualifications.
- D) Eligible candidates are internal applicants, whereas suitable candidates are external.

Answer: A

Source: "Eligible candidates have a curriculum vitae (CV) which shows, for example, the 'right' number of years in some previous post and the 'right' paper qualifications. Suitable candidates can actually do the job well."

6. In the recruitment process, which document is created to list the qualities, qualifications, education, and experience required by the person needed for the role?

- A) Job specification
- B) Job holder profile
- C) Training needs profile
- D) Curriculum vitae

Answer: B

Source: "Create a job holder profile The job specification is used to construct a profile of the person needed to carry out the job. The qualities, qualifications, education and experience required would be listed."

7. Why might piece-rate reward systems be problematic in software development environments?

- A) They encourage excessive overtime without compensation.
- B) It is difficult to isolate and quantify the work done by an individual since

development is usually a team effort.

C) They lead to rapid but poor-quality coding practices.

D) They violate modern health and safety regulations.

Answer: B

Source: "Where a computer application is being developed, it is difficult to isolate and quantify work done by an individual, as system development and support is usually a team effort."

8. In Maslow's hierarchy of needs, what is considered the highest-level need?

A) Personal safety

B) Social acceptance

C) Self-actualization

D) Financial security

Answer: C

Source: "The highest-level need, according to Maslow, is the need for 'self-actualization', the feeling that you are completely fulfilling your potential."

9. According to Herzberg's two-factor theory, which of the following is an example of a 'hygiene' or 'maintenance' factor?

A) A sense of achievement

B) The challenge of the work itself

C) The level of pay or working conditions

D) The opportunity for self-actualization

Answer: C

Source: "hygiene or maintenance factors, which can make you dissatisfied if they are not right, for example the level of pay or the working conditions;"

10. In Vroom's expectancy theory of motivation, what does the term 'instrumentality' refer to?

A) The belief that working harder will lead to a better performance.

B) The belief that better performance will be rewarded.

C) The perceived value of the resulting reward.

D) The innate drive to succeed using technical tools.

Answer: B

Source: "instrumentality: the belief that better performance will be rewarded;"

11. Which factor in the Oldham-Hackman Job Characteristics Model refers to the degree to which your work and its results are identifiable as belonging to you?

A) Skill variety

B) Task significance

C) Task identity

D) Autonomy

Answer: C

Source: "task identity: the degree to which your work and its results are identifiable as belonging to you;"

12. How does 'job enrichment' differ from 'job enlargement'?

A) Job enrichment involves carrying out a wider variety of tasks at the same level, while job enlargement involves tasks normally done at a managerial level.

B) Job enrichment involves carrying out tasks normally done at a managerial or supervisory level, while job enlargement involves a wider variety of activities.

C) Job enrichment focuses solely on financial rewards, while job enlargement focuses on training.

D) There is no difference; the terms are synonymous.

Answer: B

Source: "Job enlargement The person doing the job carries out a wider variety of activities... Job enrichment The job holder carries out tasks that are normally done at a managerial or supervisory level."

13. Research cited in the text indicates that productivity and the quality of output generally decline when work hours exceed approximately how many hours per week?

A) 35 hours

B) 40 hours

C) 50 hours

D) 60 hours

Answer: B

Source: "There is good evidence that productivity and the quality of output go down when more than about 40 hours a week are worked."

14. Which condition arises when staff do not have a clear idea of the objectives their work is supposed to fulfill or the precise scope of their responsibilities?

- A) Role conflict
- B) Role ambiguity
- C) Expectancy failure
- D) Task identity loss

Answer: B

Source: "Stress can be caused by role ambiguity when staff do not have a clear idea of the objectives that their work is supposed to be fulfilling, what is expected of them by others and the precise scope of their responsibilities."

15. In the context of project management, how should safety objectives generally be treated?

- A) As a secondary concern compared to overall project costs.
- B) As the exclusive responsibility of the human resources department.
- C) Like any other project objectives, embedded in the general management of the project.
- D) As applicable only to heavy engineering projects, not ICT development.

Answer: C

Source: "As far as the project manager is concerned, safety objectives, where appropriate, should be treated like any other project objectives, such as the level of reliability of the completed application or the overall cost of the project."

16. What is the core argument of the stockholder business ethics model associated with Milton Friedman?

- A) Employees have a primary ethical duty to the community over the organization.
- B) Commercial organizations must prioritize environmental concerns above profit.
- C) Employees have a contract to safeguard and enhance the assets of the stockholders, and pursuing other goals at their expense is dishonest.
- D) Monopolies should be broken up to protect consumer rights.

Answer: C

Source: "associated particularly with the economist Milton Friedman - that those working for commercial organizations have a contract to safeguard and enhance the assets of the stockholders of the company... pursuing other goals that might benefit the community as a whole at the expense of the stockholders would be dishonest behaviour"

17. Why do technical experts, such as ICT practitioners, hold special ethical responsibilities?

- A) They are legally exempt from normal corporate laws.
- B) They possess knowledge and expertise that others may not fully understand but upon which they depend.
- C) They are solely responsible for project budgets.
- D) They always act as the primary stakeholders in software projects.

Answer: B

Source: "These will have special ethical responsibilities as they have knowledge and expertise that others may not fully understand but upon which they depend."

18. According to the research by Cheney mentioned in the text, what is the most important influence on programmer productivity?

- A) Mathematical aptitude
- B) Communication skills
- C) Experience
- D) Age

Answer: C

Source: "looking at behavioural characteristics, the American researcher Cheney found that the most important influence on programmer productivity seemed to be experience."

19. Which term describes a situation where a person is torn between the demands of two different roles?

- A) Role ambiguity

- B) Role escalation
- C) Role conflict
- D) Role identity

Answer: C

Source: "Role conflict can also heighten stress. This is where the person is torn between the demands of two different roles."

20. In Vroom's expectancy theory, if a developer believes that no matter how hard they work they will never succeed because of a system bug, which factor is at a zero level?

- A) Expectancy
- B) Instrumentality
- C) Perceived value
- D) Objective motivation

Answer: A

Source: "You realize that you will never get it to work because of a bug, and you give up. No matter how hard you work you will not be able to succeed (zero expectancy)."

Chapter 12: Working in Teams

21. In the stages of team development, during which phase do conflicts typically arise as members attempt to exert leadership and establish operational methods?

- A) Forming
- B) Storming
- C) Norming
- D) Performing

Answer: B

Source: "Storming Conflicts arise as various members of the group try to exert leadership and the group's methods of operation are being established."

22. According to Belbin's team roles, which individual is essentially very good at generating ideas and potential solutions to problems?

- A) The chair
- B) The plant
- C) The shaper
- D) The completer-finisher

Answer: B

Source: "The plant: someone who is essentially very good at generating ideas and potential solutions to problems."

23. How is 'the shaper' described in Belbin's classification of team roles?

- A) Someone who evaluates ideas and selects the best one.
- B) Someone who is adept at finding physical resources.
- C) Rather a worrier, who helps to direct the team's attention to the important issues.
- D) Skilled at creating a good working environment.

Answer: C

Source: "The shaper: rather a worrier, who helps to direct the team's attention to the important issues."

24. In which type of group task are the judgments of individual group members pooled so that the errors of some are offset by the inputs of others?

- A) Additive tasks
- B) Compensatory tasks
- C) Disjunctive tasks
- D) Conjunctive tasks

Answer: B

Source: "With compensatory tasks the judgements of individual group members are pooled so that the errors of some are compensated for by the inputs from others."

25. Software production where different staff are responsible for different modules is an example of which type of task, where progress is governed by the rate of the slowest performer?

- A) Conjunctive tasks
- B) Disjunctive tasks

- C) Additive tasks
- D) Compensatory tasks

Answer: A

Source: "Conjunctive tasks are where progress is governed by the rate of the slowest performer. Software production where different staff are responsible for different modules is a good example of this."

26. What phenomenon occurs when some individuals in a collective task do not make their proper contribution to the group effort?

- A) Risky shift
- B) Group heedfulness
- C) Social loafing
- D) Escalation of commitment

Answer: C

Source: "With all types of collective task, but particularly with additive ones, there is a danger of social loafing, where some individuals do not make their proper contribution."

27. The phenomenon where individuals in groups make decisions that carry more risk than they would make on their own is known as:

- A) Group heedfulness
- B) Social loafing
- C) The risky shift
- D) Escalation of commitment

Answer: C

Source: "In fact, people in groups sometimes make decisions that carry more risk than where they make the decision on their own. This is known as the risky shift."

28. Which technique endeavors to collate the judgments of a number of geographically dispersed experts without bringing them face to face?

- A) Joint Application Development (JAD)
- B) Delphi technique
- C) Brainstorming
- D) Egoless programming

Answer: B

Source: "The Delphi technique endeavours to collate the judgements of a number of experts without actually bringing them face to face."

29. Gerald Weinberg's concept of 'egoless programming' primarily encourages which practice among software developers?

- A) Working strictly independently without external input.
- B) Reading and reviewing each other's programs.
- C) Establishing a rigid hierarchy of chief programmers.
- D) Eliminating all documentation from the software process.

Answer: B

Source: "Gerald Weinberg made the then revolutionary suggestion that programmers and programming team leaders should read each others' programs. Programs would become in effect the common property of the programming group and programming would become 'egoless'."

30. In a chief programmer team, what is the primary role of the 'co-pilot'?

- A) To maintain the actual code.
- B) To write up the documentation drafted by the chief programmer.
- C) To discuss problems with the chief programmer and write some code.
- D) To independently verify and integrate the work completed by the testers.

Answer: C

Source: "He or she is assisted by a co-pilot, with whom the chief programmer can discuss problems and who writes some code."

31. In the Scrum software development process, what is the typical duration of a 'sprint'?

- A) One to four days
- B) One to four weeks
- C) One to four months
- D) Six months to a year

Answer: B

Source: "This phase is now followed by a number of sprints, each of which typically lasts between one and four weeks."

32. Which organizational structure divides developers into groups based on their specialization or experience, and assigns them temporarily to different projects?

- A) Democratic format
- B) Matrix format
- C) Project format
- D) Functional format

Answer: D

Source: "In the functional format, the developers are divided into functional groups based on their specialization or experience. ... For carrying out specific activities, different projects borrow developers from the corresponding functional groups"

33. What is an advantage of the project format over the functional format in software development?

- A) It minimizes the production of good quality documents.
- B) It allows team members to build up familiarity with the software over a long period, facilitating efficient maintenance.
- C) It solves the staffing problem by returning developers to a functional pool when not needed.
- D) It promotes a technically oriented career ladder rather than a managerial one.

Answer: B

Source: "Further, the project team members build up familiarity with the software over a relatively long period of time and can efficiently carry out maintenance activities."

34. Which team structure does not enforce any formal team hierarchy, allowing decisions to be taken based on open discussions?

- A) Chief programmer team
- B) Democratic team
- C) Mixed control team
- D) Strong matrix team

Answer: B

Source: "The democratic team structure, as the name implies, does not enforce any formal team hierarchy. Decisions are taken based on discussions, where any member is free to discuss with any other member"

35. The mixed control team structure combines elements of which two team structures?

- A) Functional and matrix structures
- B) Democratic and chief-programmer structures
- C) Scrum and extreme programming structures
- D) Egoless and strong matrix structures

Answer: B

Source: "The mixed team structure, as the name implies, draws ideas from both the democratic and chief-programmer team structures."

36. In coordination theory, a dependency where a project activity relies on a product being delivered first is known as a:

- A) Shared resource dependency
- B) Task-subtask dependency
- C) Usability dependency
- D) Producer-customer dependency

Answer: D

Source: "Producer-customer ('right time') relationships. A project activity may depend on a product being delivered first."

37. According to the categorization of communication methods by time and place constraints, which of the following is an example of a "Same time / Different place" communication?

- A) Meetings
- B) Telephone
- C) Noticeboards
- D) E-mail

Answer: B

Source: "TABLE 12.1 Time/place constraints on some communication methods... Same time / Different place: Telephone"

38. Which of the following is identified as a potential advantage of utilizing dispersed or 'virtual' teams?

- A) Increased overhead costs for on-site accommodation.
- B) The elimination of distinct time zones.
- C) The ability to utilize people in different time zones to reduce task durations.
- D) A reduced need for rigorous product quality assessment.

Answer: C

Source: "Advantage can be taken of people working in different time zones to reduce task durations - for example, software developers can deliver new versions of code to testers in a different time zone who can test it and deliver the results back at the start of the next working day."

39. Which type of position power is based on a person's title conferring a special status?

- A) Coercive power
- B) Reward power
- C) Expert power
- D) Legitimate power

Answer: D

Source: "legitimate power, which is based on a person's title conferring a special status;"

40. A manager who makes decisions participatively but maintains close supervision of the implementation is adopting which leadership style?

- A) Directive autocrat
- B) Permissive autocrat
- C) Directive democrat
- D) Permissive democrat

Answer: C

Source: "directive democrat: makes decisions participatively, close supervision of implementation;"
